

Forms

Introduction to forms

Picture this, you have found your calling and have decided that you are developing a website for yourself. Now, your website is such that it needs all the generic features we would normally expect, like basic sign up information and members log in. Collecting this information is like filling out a form, isn't it? A “form” in website design and development means pulling information about the user together in one page.

Viewing the form

As a user, what is the first thing you see when you are trying to get beyond the homepage of a members only website? Yes, “the form.” As a web developer, you will need to create the route for visual appearance of the form.

Let's create a basic form now, shall we?

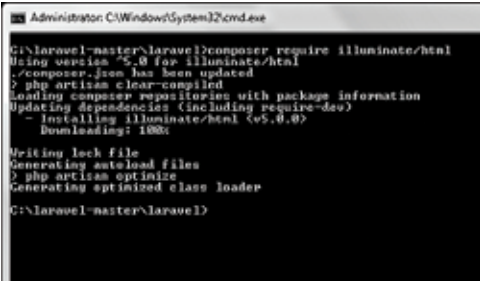
Laravel provides several easy options like text boxes, radio buttons, checkboxes and drop-down menus to populate several fields on your form which is your website's information gathering point. This could be a simple username-password log in system or a more elaborate form as re-constructing your family tree back to Adam.

Laravel provides various in-built tags to handle HTML forms easily and securely. All the major elements of HTML are generated using Laravel. To support this, we need to add HTML package to Laravel from the Laravel library using composer. Let's see how that's done.

Step 1 – Before we go about creating our form, we need to configure some items in Laravel. Type in the following command to add the HTML package using composer.

```
composer require illuminate/html
```

Step 2 – You have now added the HTML package successfully to Laravel. It will look like the image seen below:



```
Administrator: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
C:\laravel-master\laravel>composer require illuminate/html
Using version ^5.0 for illuminate/html
./composer.json has been updated
? php artisan clear-compiled
Loading composer repositories with package information
Updating dependencies (including require-dev)
- Installing illuminate/html (v5.0.0)
  Downloading: 100%
Writing lock file
Generating autoload files
? php artisan optimize
Generating optimized class loader
C:\laravel-master\laravel>
```

Step 3 – As a next step, you can now add this HTML package to